

Digital Media II - 008

Boardventure: Spin, Play, Win

Game Title: BoardRush

BoardCraft Creations

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1. Introduction and Motivation - R

This project is inspired by the game of life and other board games we enjoy playing. The motivation behind this game is to create a fun online game for people who feel bored with traditional board games. Our game aims to provide a fun experience that is accessible to everyone. Additionally, the game will feature interactive pop-ups with mini games that enhance the gameplay experience, adding excitement and unpredictability.

2. Background and Related Work - J

a. First Related Work: Game of Life

The Game of Life serves as a strong inspiration for this project due to its structured board game mechanics, player progression system, and emphasis on chance-based movement combined with strategic decision-making. Like *The Game of Life*, our game involves players taking turns, spinning a wheel to determine movement, and encountering spaces that impact their journey.

One key similarity is the presence of **event-based spaces**. In *The Game of Life*, players land on spaces that trigger life events such as career changes, financial gains or losses, and other milestone moments. Similarly, our game will feature **action card spaces**, where players will engage in mini-games before proceeding. These action spaces introduce unpredictability and variation, making each playthrough unique.

Another important parallel is the **currency or point-based progression system**. In *The Game of Life*, financial success is a major factor in determining the winner. Likewise, in our game, players will earn points or in-game currency based on their performance in mini-games. Rather

than simply racing to the finish, success will depend on how well players perform throughout the game.

Additionally, *The Game of Life* emphasizes a **blend of luck and player choice**. While movement is determined by chance (via the spinner), the outcomes of life events and financial decisions impact the final standings. Our game adopts a similar structure, where luck influences movement, but skill in mini-games determines overall success.

By drawing inspiration from *The Game of Life*'s turn-based structure, chance-based movement, and event-driven spaces, our game aims to provide an engaging and interactive experience while introducing dynamic mini-games and animations to set it apart.

b. Second Related Work/Inspiration: Monopoly

Monopoly serves as a key inspiration for this project due to its structured board game mechanics, player progression system, and strategic decision-making elements. Like Monopoly, our game involves players taking turns, moving across a game board based on a randomized movement mechanic (in our case, a spinning wheel rather than dice), and encountering specific spaces that impact their progress.

One of the most significant similarities is the presence of **action spaces**—in Monopoly, players may land on properties, Chance or Community Chest cards, or other special tiles that require them to take an action. Similarly, in our game, action cards will introduce unique mini-games that players must complete, adding an element of unpredictability and engagement.

Another parallel is the **currency system**. In Monopoly, players accumulate and manage money throughout the game, which determines their success. In our game, players will earn in-game currency or points based on their performance in mini-games, influencing the final outcome. This mechanic ensures that the winner is not simply the first player to reach the final tile but rather the one who has earned the most through skill and strategy.

Additionally, Monopoly's **balance of luck and strategy** is reflected in our design. While movement is randomized, strategic decisions—such as how well a player performs in mini-games—will significantly impact their success. This blend of chance and skill makes for an engaging and competitive gameplay experience.

By drawing inspiration from Monopoly's turn-based mechanics, action spaces, and money-based scoring system, our game seeks to create an exciting and interactive experience while introducing fresh elements such as animated movement and mini-games to differentiate itself.

3. Problem Statement - R

Our goal is to design and develop a fun, engaging board game that targets individuals aged 7-19. We aim to deliver a game that is simple to understand yet filled with enjoyable surprises, challenges, and interactive elements to keep players entertained during their free time.

4. Proposed Solution Strategy and Implementation - J

a. Player Movement Animation

To enhance the gameplay experience, an animation system will be implemented to visually represent player movement across the board. When a player spins the wheel, their game piece will move step-by-step across the appropriate number of spaces, ensuring a smooth and immersive transition.

b. Action Cards & Mini-Games

Certain spaces on the board will feature action cards that trigger unique mini games. When a player lands on one of these spaces, they must complete the associated mini-game before proceeding. These mini games will serve as a core gameplay mechanic, adding variety and strategy to the experience.

c. Currency & Score Tracking System

A point or currency system will be implemented to reward players based on their mini-game performance. This system will allow players to accumulate points, which will play a key role in determining the game's winner.

d. Game Conclusion & Winner Determination

The game will conclude when all players reach the final tile on the board. At this stage, the player with the highest accumulated score or currency will be declared the winner. This scoring system ensures that success is based on both progress and performance throughout the game.

5. Resource Requirements - J

a. Development Tools:

- Programming Language: JavaScript
- Program: P5js, used as the website for us to make our code.

b. Hardware:

- A computer/laptop for each team member.
- Access to the internet for research and collaboration.

c. Additional Learning Resources

- We may need something like YouTube or some other learning resources as our current knowledge may not be sufficient for this project.
- Google or other such search engines may be needed to find additional references.

6. Timeline of Activities - R

Activity	Programmer	Start Time	End Time
Create the game board and background elements (sandy-colored board, light blue background)	Jolomi	January 16	January 21
Design and implement players and their starting positions	Ruhani	January 16	January 21
Develop the spinner mechanics and link them to player movement	Ruhani	January 16	January 21
Implement player animations for movement on the board	Jolomi	January 21	January 30
Set up stop signs on the board where players will land and stop	Jolomi	January 21	January 30
Integrate background music and sound effects for better immersion	Jolomi	January 21	February 4
Design and implement the instructions screen that appears at the beginning of the game	Ruhani	January 23	February 11
Make an animation/display for the end of the game	Jolomi	January 28	February 11
Develop the animation for action cards, ensuring they are randomized and do not repeat	Ruhani	January 30	February 18
Design visually appealing action cards and their mechanics	Jolomi	January 30	February 25
Make action cards, with good design, and fun activities	Both	February 6	March 4
Design and integrate mini-games that will appear within the action cards	Both of us will make 1-2 each	February 13	March 11
User testing and debugging (playtesting to ensure smooth gameplay and fix issues)	Both	March 11	March 18
Final polish of game design, UI, and UX improvements	Both	March 18	March 25
Game launch and presentation preparation	Both	March 18	March 25

7. Expected Outcome - R

We expect the result of our project to be a fun multiplayer game.

By the end of the project, we expect to have a fully functional board game where:

- **The Game Logic is Functional:** The players should be able to play a full game against each other. They will spin the spinner and work through the action cards to gain points. The player with most points at the end will win.
- **Fun Minigames through Action Cards:** Every time an action card pops up, there will be a fun activity the players can play and earn points from.
- **Valid Gameplay and Win Condition:** The game will ensure that the game ends when all players reach the end of the board. Then, the statistics will be shown and there will be a celebratory page once the game is complete with an option to restart.
- **User Interface:** A simple and good-looking game experience

By implementing this project, we aim to demonstrate our understanding of what we have learned in our DMII class.